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Refugee Voices Take Center Stage at Cannes 2025

This year's **Cannes Film Festival** (May 13–25) brings powerful stories of displacement, identity, and connection to the big screen, including the following films (all nominated for the *Un Certain Regard* prize):

🎥 ***Aisha Can't Fly Away*** *– Morad Mostafa*
A Somali caregiver in Cairo seeks freedom from abuse, navigating racism and a broken system that keeps her trapped.

🎥 ***My Father's Shadow*** *– Akinola Davies Jr.*
Two young brothers follow their father through a politically tense Lagos in 1993, confronting absence, memory, and belonging in a fractured family.

🎥 ***Once Upon a Time in Gaza*** *– Arab & Tarzan Nasser*
A story of the human essence of Gaza and its people that remains at the core of their existence despite the occupation, siege, and inhumane conditions.

This year's festival also pays tribute to Palestinian photojournalist **Fatima Hassouna**, killed in an Israeli airstrike on Gaza on April 16, one day after learning that her documentary – ***Put Your Soul on Your Hand and Walk***, directed by *Sepideh Farsi* – had been selected to premiere at Cannes.

📌 NaTakallam's latest blog article celebrates powerful **Palestinian films**. Read more here.

Films are an excellent tool for your language training. Additionally, watching a film offers a window into another world, and conversing in a new language immerses you in it.

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"Fear is the way that they win... don't let them win."

At the Cannes press conference for his new film *Eddington*, Actor Pedro Pascal, known for his roles in *Game of Thrones*, *The Mandalorian*, *The Last of Us*, and more, took a stand against fear-driven politics and immigration policies.

Drawing from his own experience as the child of Chilean refugees, Pascal emphasized the importance of storytelling in confronting political chaos and advocating for migrant protections.

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